FMAM 2026 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 February 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v2.0 · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

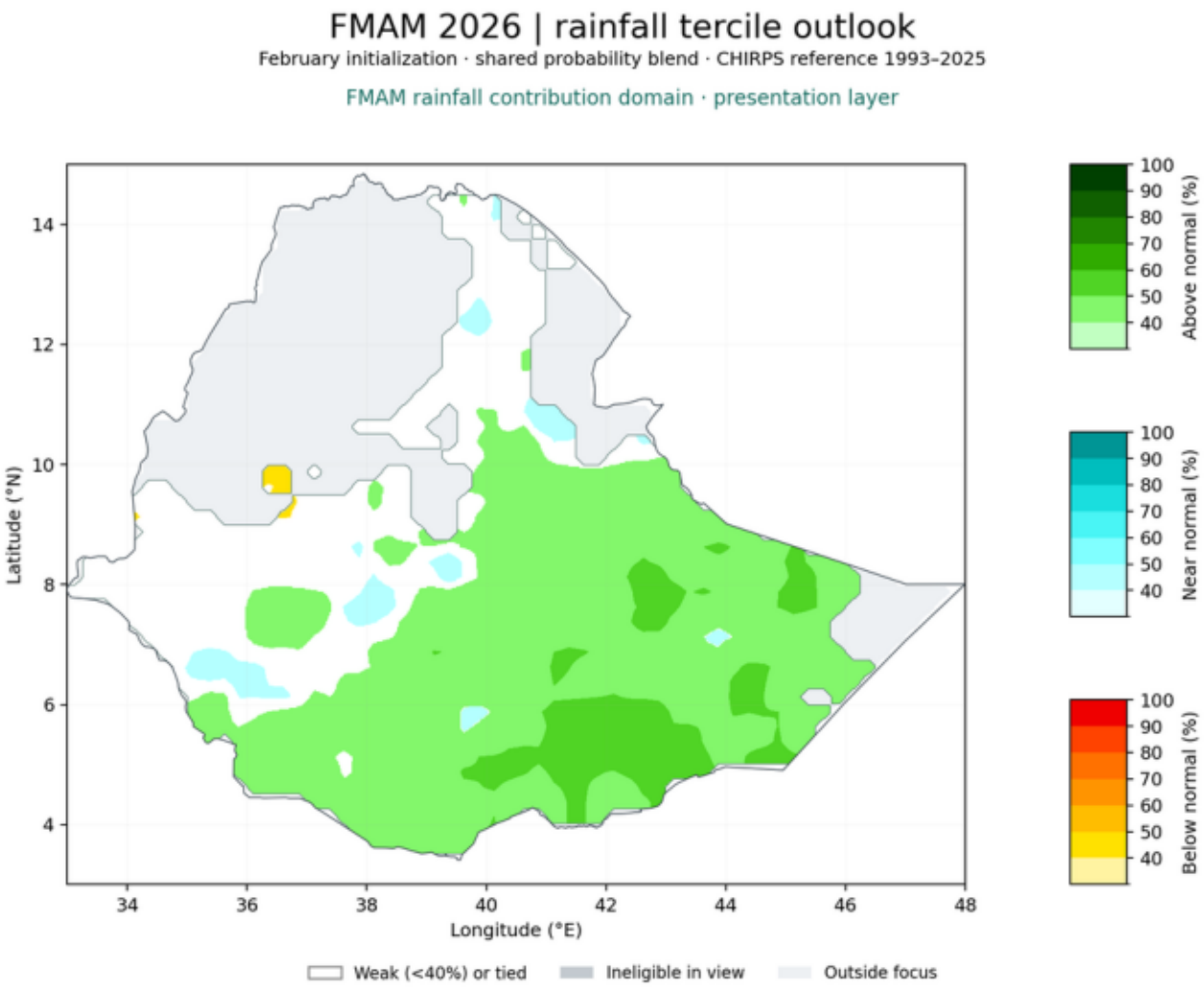
The forecast leans toward above normal rainfall in the FMAM rainfall contribution domain: averaged over the area, the local probability of above normal is 43%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 316 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 287 mm (+29 mm, +10%).

Below normal 24% **Near normal 33%** **Above normal 43%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: Weak tilt toward above normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (FMAM rainfall contribution domain): Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain. Probability skill (RPSS) +0.020, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval −0.042 to +0.077; better than climatology in 15 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.



Display interpolation: 12×; Gaussian σ=0.6 native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a February-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

All targets, evidence and record

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

Target	Below/near/above	Coverage	Anomaly	Verification status
FMAM 2026	24% / 33% / 43%	100%	+29 mm	Verification published
Feb 2026	28% / 45% / 27%	81%	−2 mm	Verification published
Mar 2026	31% / 34% / 35%	91%	+4 mm	Verification published
Apr 2026	27% / 30% / 43%	100%	+26 mm	Verification published
May 2026	35% / 33% / 32%	100%	−2 mm	Verification published

Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

Target	RPSS (95% interval)	Yrs better	Holm p	In words
FMAM	+0.020 (−0.042 to +0.077)	15/24	1.000	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Feb	+0.145 (+0.050 to +0.247)	17/24	0.018	Moderate improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Mar	+0.011 (−0.032 to +0.054)	17/24	1.000	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Apr	+0.012 (−0.033 to +0.051)	14/24	1.000	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
May	+0.011 (−0.056 to +0.061)	17/24	1.000	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain

Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

Target	RPSS	CRPSS	Bias	Forecast / observed anomaly	Observed below/near/above
FMAM 2026	+0.130	+0.062	−27.0 mm	+29 / +56 mm	3% / 45% / 52%
Feb 2026	+0.142	+0.048	−2.1 mm	−2 / 0 mm	32% / 44% / 24%
Mar 2026	+0.066	+0.057	−72.1 mm	+4 / +77 mm	0% / 2% / 98%
Apr 2026	−0.159	−0.633	+41.9 mm	+26 / −16 mm	44% / 37% / 19%
May 2026	+0.002	−0.056	+3.6 mm	−2 / −5 mm	38% / 44% / 18%

Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 February 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Feb 2026 – 31 May 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 9 Oct 2026 (after the target period ended, before this project downloaded its observations; SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v2.0 FMAM 1993–2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: May 2026 (Feb, Mar, Apr, May)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v2.0 p25 by_month listing checked 10 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026; Feb 2026 file not found

Verification last run: 10 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend (λ = 0.44 for FMAM) · code 50ca522

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

Monthly tercile outlooks

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

